

# Unit 5

# Hydrosphere

## Chapter Outline


**5.1** Introduction
**5.2** Distribution of Land and Water in the Earth
**5.3** Fresh water
**5.4** Cryosphere
**5.5** Oceans and Seas
**5.6** Oceans of the world
**5.7** Maritime zones
**5.8** Relief of ocean
**5.9** Ocean temperature
**5.10** Salinity of the ocean
**5.11** Ocean movements


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## Learning Objectives:

- *To understand the importance of hydrosphere*
- *Acquire knowledge on evolution of ocean and ocean relief features*
- *Appreciate the ocean movements and their influence on the earth's climate*

## 5.1 Introduction

**"நீர்இன்று அமையாது உலகெனின் யார்யார்க்கும் வான்இன்று அமையாது ஒழுக்கு"**

**"World cannot survive without water and morality cannot exist without rain"**

As thirukkural quotes, water is the most important resource in the world. Over 90% of the world's supply of fresh water is in Antarctica. You must know that 85% of the world population lives in the driest half of the planet. Now we shall learn about the hydrosphere in detail.

DO YOU KNOW?

70% of human brain is water.

Water is the most common substance found on earth. It is an important constituent of all life forms on the earth. Hydrosphere is one among the four spheres of the earth. The hydrosphere includes the water on the surface of the earth, the water below the surface called ground water and the water in the atmosphere above earth's surface. Oceans, rivers, lakes and glaciers form part of surface water. There is substantial



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